

FAERIA

Another brilliant merger of card game and strategy, *Faeria* is a card game where you build the board as you play. When the game starts, there are vacant tiles between you and your opponent. How you play is up to you,



you can beeline to your opponent if you so please, or spread out and look for *Faeria* wells that are dotted across the map, which are the magical resource of the game. You will need them if you plan to play some of the more powerful cards in the game. *Faeria* is also very new player friendly, and encourages deck building from the get go, and makes the deck building process easier for new players. It encourages players to pick codexes, which are a collection of three cards that synergise. You build your entire deck out of these codexes so you're guaranteed to have cards that work well with each other. This method of deck building also makes it one of the more unique deck building mechanics on this list.

GRIFTLANDS

Combining RPG and deck building, all of the actions in *Griftlands* are determined by cards. From speech checks to combat moves, currency, and even character traits, it's all in the cards. As you progress through the game, you unlock more cards, which in turn



unlock more actions for your character. The game itself is charming and teeming with personality; and you can, of course, start all over again and have

a different experience, because the game has roguelike elements as well.

CARD HOG

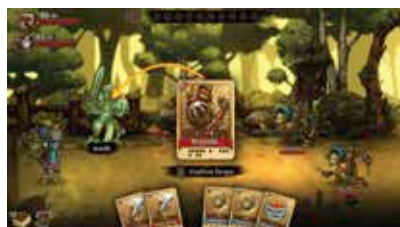
An interesting mix of card battler, dungeon crawler and roguelike, *Card Hog* is an interesting card game where the



cards on the table double as a map for your character to traverse. This traversal doubles as the deck-building element as well, which is pretty darn creative. This new approach to deck building forces you to think and plan differently to traditional deck builders and card battlers. Maps are littered with enemies, weapons, loot and traps. How you navigate and build your deck is up to you.

STEAMWORLD QUEST

Take a turn-based RPG and combine it with deck-building gameplay and you get *SteamWorld Quest*. This single-



player game has you assemble a team of heroes with unique abilities, which are represented by cards. Unlike the more PvP focused card games on this list, *SteamWorld Quest* only has around 100 cards, but it's more than enough within the game's world. The game also avoids the usual RPG tropes; let's just say the healer is not necessarily only good at healing.

ANCIENT ENEMY

I know we said 'not including *Solitaire*' in the intro, but this is not exactly *Solitaire*. Okay it kinda is. *Ancient Enemy* is a blend of *Solitaire* with a turn-based combat system, puzzles, and an RPG.



You take on the role of a mage who has awakened in a world that has been destroyed by evil. As you progress through the game and defeat increasingly challenging opponents, you acquire new cards which will help you take down the more stronger foes in the game. Developer Alien Games is known for blending *Solitaire* with other genres of games. Their previous title, *Shadowhand*, is also worth checking out, but it's fairly similar to *Ancient Enemy*.

GLOOMHAVEN

Like *Magic: the Gathering*, *Gloomhaven* is a digital recreation of a tabletop game. The game itself is an amalgamation of turn-based, co-op, RPG, and strategy, with, of course, deck building. You crawl through dungeons facing a variety of foes, each requiring different strategies to take down. You earn new gear, loot and cards as you



progress, and cards can even be modified. The best part about such games going digital is being able to find people from across the world to play with. This is a fairly accurate rendition of the board game, so the experience is the same, or only amplified by the visuals and animations.

There are a lot more creative uses of card game mechanics in other games too, of which we've missed many I'm sure. We tried to avoid games where the cards were a secondary mechanic, or not a core aspect of the game. That being said, do let us know what your favourite card-based games are by writing in to us at feedback@skoar.in *